



SIPA: KANTO CLICKER

OFFICIAL GAME MANUAL



Eskinita Rhythm & Precision Arcade
Inspired by the traditional Filipino street game Sipa
Timing is Everything • Swak • Puwede • Daplis

A Browser-Playable 2D Arcade Game
Built with Python & Pygame-CE • Deployed via Pygbag WebAssembly

Version 1.0



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1. WHAT IS SIPA: KANTO CLICKER?

Sipa: Kanto Clicker is a browser-playable 2D arcade rhythm game inspired by *Sipa* — the traditional Filipino street game where players keep a rattan shuttlecock (or a lead washer with colorful plastic tassels) airborne using only their feet, knees, and elbows.

The game combines the timing and precision mechanics of rhythm games like *Osu!* and *Elite Beat Agents* with the cultural flavor of Filipino street (kanto) life. You play on a virtual *eskinita* (alley) complete with a sari-sari store, chalk court markings, a parked tricycle, and spectators cheering from the sidelines.

Your goal is simple: **keep the sipa in the air** by clicking on approach rings at the perfect moment. The better your timing, the higher your score. Miss too many kicks and the sipa drops — *Bagsak!*

2. HOW TO PLAY — GETTING STARTED

Step 1: Open the Game

Open the game in your web browser. The game runs directly in your browser — no downloads or installations needed. You can also run it locally using Python with `python main.py`.

Step 2: Unlock Audio

Modern web browsers require a user click before playing any sound. Your very first click on the title screen unlocks the game's audio system. You will see a flashing prompt: "Browser Audio Unlocks on First Click".

Step 3: Choose Your Difficulty

On the title screen, select your preferred difficulty from the four tabs: **Madali** (Easy), **Sakto** (Normal), **Mahirap** (Hard), or **Pikon Mode** (Extreme). You can also use number keys 1–4 as shortcuts.

Step 4: Start Playing!

Click the large **"SIMULAN"** (Start) button or press **SPACE**, **ENTER**, **Z**, or **X** to begin. The game will transition to the street court and your first sipa will be served!

3. CONTROLS

Action	Mouse	Keyboard
Kick / Hit Target	Left Click on ring	Z or X key
Pause Game	Click PAUSE button	ESC key
Resume (while paused)	Click RESUME	ESC or SPACE
Restart Round (paused)	Click RESTART	R key
Quit to Title (paused)	Click QUIT	Q key
Play Again (results)	Click PLAY AGAIN	SPACE or ENTER
Return to Title (results)	Click MENU	ESC or Q key
Select Difficulty	Click difficulty tab	1, 2, 3, or 4 key

Note: A crosshair cursor appears during gameplay to help you aim precisely at the approach rings.

4. THE GAME SCREEN — WHAT YOU SEE

During gameplay, your screen is divided into several visual layers:

- **Background Scenery** — A parallax-scrolling Filipino street (*eskinita*) with a sari-sari store, utility poles with wires, a parked tricycle, chalk court markings, drifting clouds, and a warm skyline gradient.
- **The Street Court** — A chalk-drawn horizontal "KICK ZONE" line marking where hit targets appear. This is your primary focus area.
- **Your Avatar** — A procedurally animated 2D character wearing a sando (tank top), basketball shorts, and chinelas (flip-flops). They automatically position themselves near the kick zone to meet incoming approach rings.
- **Taya (NPC)** — The opposing street challenger standing on the left sideline. Taya observes your performance, shouts Filipino callouts, and reacts with animated emotions.
- **The Sipa** — A spinning lead washer with colorful plastic tassels trailing behind it. This is the "ball" you keep airborne by clicking the approach rings.
- **Approach Rings** — Shrinking circles that converge on a central hit target. Click when the ring perfectly overlaps the inner circle for the best score.
- **HUD (Heads-Up Display)** — Fixed overlay showing your Score, Combo, Accuracy %, Pikon Meter, active modifiers, and serve progress.

5. GAMEPLAY FLOW — STEP BY STEP

Step 1: Serve (Tira) — Taya shouts a callout ("Salo!", "Tira na!") and the sipa is launched from the sideline in a parabolic arc toward the court.

Step 2: Approach Ring Appears — As the sipa reaches the top of its arc and begins descending, the game predicts where it will land and spawns an approach ring at that position. The ring shrinks steadily toward the inner hit circle.

Step 3: Click to Kick! — Click (or press Z/X) when the approach ring aligns with the inner circle. Your timing determines the judgment: **Swak!** (Perfect), **Puwede** (Good), **Daplis** (OK), or **Bagsak!** (Miss).

Step 4: Sipa Relaunches — A successful kick sends the sipa back into the air with a new trajectory. Your avatar automatically performs the appropriate kick animation.

Step 5: Keep the Rally Going! — Each round consists of **15 serves**. After all serves are completed and the sipa lands, the round ends.

Step 6: Results Screen — Your final score, accuracy, max combo, hit breakdown, and street rank are displayed. Choose to play again or return to the title screen.

If you miss a kick (Bagsak!), the sipa falls to the ground and bounces to a stop. After a brief pause, a new serve is automatically launched.

6. HIT TIMING & JUDGMENTS

The core of the game is **precision timing**. When the approach ring shrinks to match the inner hit circle, that is the perfect moment to click. Your timing is measured in milliseconds (ms) of deviation from the ideal moment:

Judgment	Timing Window	Base Points	Meaning
Swak!	±25 ms	300	Perfect!
Puwede	±70 ms	100	That'll do / Acceptable
Daplis	±120 ms	50	Barely grazed it
Bagsak!	> 120 ms or miss	0	Dropped / Miss

A floating text popup appears at the hit position showing your judgment. **Swak!** hits produce golden ripple VFX and particle bursts, while **Bagsak!** causes a red screen-shake effect.

7. SCORING SYSTEM

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Your score is calculated using this formula:

$$\text{Points} = \text{BasePoints} \times (1 + \min(\text{Combo}, 100) / 25) \times \text{DifficultyMultiplier}$$

Where:

- **BasePoints** — 300 (Swak!), 100 (Puwede), 50 (Daplis), or 0 (Bagsak!)
- **Combo** — Your current consecutive hit streak (capped at 100 for the formula)
- **DifficultyMultiplier** — Increases with harder difficulties (1.0x to 4.0x)

This means the same **Swak!** hit at a 50-combo on Mahirap difficulty earns significantly more than a 1-combo Swak! on Madali. Building and maintaining combos is the key to high scores!

8. COMBO SYSTEM

Every successful hit (Swak!, Puwede, or Daplis) increases your **Combo Counter** by 1. A **Bagsak!** (miss) resets your combo to zero.

Combos serve two purposes:

- **Score Multiplier** — Higher combos amplify every hit's point value (see formula above).
- **Pikon Meter Boost** — Combos of 10+ make Taya angrier faster, unlocking modifiers sooner.

Combo Milestones: At every 10th combo (10, 20, 30...), the crowd cheers! Taya also reacts — at 10 combos she's impressed, at 20+ she enters **Pikon Rage**.

Your **Max Combo** (the highest streak achieved in a round) is displayed on the results screen and contributes to your overall street rank evaluation.

9. THE PIKON METER — TAYA'S RAGE GAUGE

The **Pikon Meter** is a dynamic annoyance gauge displayed at the top-center of the screen. It represents how frustrated Taya is becoming as you play well. The better you perform, the angrier Taya gets — and the harder the game becomes!

How the Pikon Meter Fills:

- **Swak!** hits add +5.0% base
- **Puwede** hits add +3.0% base
- **Daplis** hits add +1.0% base
- Combos of 10+ multiply the gain by 1.5×
- Higher difficulty settings have faster Pikon rates (0.8× to 1.6×)

How the Pikon Meter Decreases:

- A **Bagsak!** (miss) immediately drops the meter by 15%.
- Inactivity for more than 3 seconds decays the meter at 2% per second.

Pikon Meter Color Guide:

Meter Level	Color	Mood
0% – 29%	Green	Calm / Observing

Meter Level	Color	Mood
30% – 49%	Yellow	Getting annoyed
50% – 79%	Orange	Frustrated
80% – 100%	Crimson (pulsing)	PIKON RAGE!

10. DIFFICULTY LEVELS

Choose your challenge before each round. Higher difficulties reward more points but demand sharper reflexes!

Difficulty	Score Mult	Approach Rate	Pikon Speed	Description
Madali (Easy)	1.0×	AR 5.0 (Slow)	0.8× (Slow)	Relaxed pace, great for beginners.
Sakto (Normal)	1.5×	AR 6.0 (Standard)	1.0× (Normal)	Balanced challenge. The default setting.
Mahirap (Hard)	2.5×	AR 7.5 (Fast)	1.3× (Fast)	Wind starts immediately. Faster rings.
Pikon Mode (Extreme)	4.0×	AR 9.0 (Extreme)	1.6× (Aggressive)	All modifiers active from the start!

*Tip: Start with **Madali** to learn the timing, then work your way up to **Pikon Mode** for the ultimate test of Filipino street reflexes!*

11. TAYA MODIFIERS — DYNAMIC CHALLENGES

As the Pikon Meter rises, Taya activates **gameplay modifiers** that change how targets behave. These are shown as active tags on the HUD (e.g., "MODS: HANGIN • BILIS").

Modifier	Threshold	Effect
Hangin (Wind)	$\geq 30\%$	A lateral wind pushes the sipa sideways during flight, making landing predictions less predictable.
Bilis (Speed Up)	$\geq 50\%$	Approach rings shrink 20% faster, giving you less time to react.
Dalawa (Double)	$\geq 65\%$	A secondary quick-target appears alongside the main target. Hit both for maximum points!
Pikon Rage	$\geq 80\%$	Rings shrink 30% faster. Wind intensifies. Taya shakes fists and shouts rage callouts.
Loko-Loko (Chaos)	$\geq 95\%$	Random spatial jitter on target positions — targets spawn slightly offset from their predicted position!

On **Mahirap** and **Pikon Mode**, some modifiers are active from the very start, regardless of the Pikon Meter level.

12. RANKS & STREET TITLES

At the end of each round, you are awarded a **Street Rank** based on your overall accuracy. The rank letter and title are displayed on a decorated badge with jeepney-inspired diamond studs and banderitas (festive pennants).

Grade	Accuracy	Street Title	Meaning
S	$\geq 95\%$	Hari ng Kanto	King of the Street Corner
A	$\geq 85\%$	Beterano	Veteran / Seasoned Player
B	$\geq 75\%$	Marunong	Knows What They're Doing
C	$\geq 60\%$	Bagito	Newbie / Beginner
F	$< 60\%$	Kulelat	Dead Last / Bottom of the Barrel

Achieving **S** or **A** rank triggers celebratory sparkle particles on the grade badge. Aim for **Hari ng Kanto** — King of the Street Corner!

13. MEET THE CHARACTERS



The Player (Ikaw!)

A nimble Filipino street baller dressed in a white sando (tank top), red basketball shorts with a gold racing stripe, and trusty chinelas (flip-flops). They have 7 animated states:

- **Idle** — Standing stance with a gentle bob.
- **Paa Kick (Inside Foot)** — Right leg sweeps inward, perfect for low targets.
- **Tuhod Kick (Knee Bump)** — Knee thrust for mid-height targets.
- **Siko Kick (Elbow Rebound)** — Crouch with downward elbow strike for high targets.
- **Miss Stumble** — Off-balance stumble animation when you miss a kick.
- **Celebrate** — Fist pump triggered on combo milestones.
- **Hit Recover** — Smooth transition back to idle after a successful kick.

Taya (The Challenger)

Taya is the opposing player / game director. He wears a bright yellow shirt, dark shorts, a backwards cap, and has a towel draped over his shoulder. He stands on the left sideline and has 6 behavioral states:

- **Observing** — Crossed arms, watchfully waiting.
- **Calling** — Hand cupped to mouth, shouting serve callouts ("Salo!", "Tira na!").
- **Taunting** — Pointing and laughing when you miss ("Bagsak!", "Kaya pa ba?").
- **Impressed** — Hands on head in disbelief at your high combos ("Lakas mo ah!").
- **Pikon Rage** — Clenched fists trembling with anger ("Pikon na 'ko ah!").
- **Mocking** — Dismissive shrug ("Daplis lang pala!").

14. PAUSE MENU

Press **ESC** or click the **PAUSE** button (top-left corner) during gameplay to open the pause overlay. The game freezes and background music pauses.

The pause menu offers three options:

- **ITULOY (Resume)** [ESC / SPACE] — Return to gameplay.
- **UMULIT (Restart)** [R] — Restart the current round from scratch.
- **LUMABAS (Quit)** [Q] — Return to the title screen.

The header reads: "**HINTO MUNA (PAUSED)**" — which translates to "Hold on for a moment." Below it, the subtitle says: "*Pahinga muna sa laro, pre.*" — "Take a break from the game, bro."

15. TIPS & STRATEGIES

1. Watch the Ring, Not the Sipa: Focus on the approach ring shrinking toward the inner circle. Click the instant they overlap — don't chase the sipa with your eyes.

2. Use Keyboard for Speed: Pressing Z or X is often faster and more consistent than mouse clicking, especially during rapid Dalawa (double) targets.

3. Keep Your Combo Alive: A miss resets your combo to zero and tanks your score multiplier. One consistent Puwede is worth more than risking a Swak! and getting Bagsak!

4. Learn the Wind: When the Hangin (Wind) modifier activates, the sipa drifts laterally. Anticipate where the approach ring will appear based on wind direction.

5. Don't Panic During Pikon Rage: At 80%+ Pikon, rings shrink 30% faster. Stay calm, breathe, and focus on consistency over perfection.

6. Double Targets (Dalawa): A secondary target appears alongside the main one at 65%+ Pikon. Try to hit the quick bonus target first — it expires sooner.

7. Start Easy, Build Up: Use Madali difficulty to learn the timing windows and visual language. Once you consistently get B rank, move to Sakto.

8. Accuracy Over Score: Your street rank is based purely on accuracy, not total score. A round of all Puwede hits (100% accuracy? No — but high accuracy!) beats a round with a few Swak! and many Bagsak!.

9. Listen for Taya's Callouts: Taya shouts Filipino phrases that hint at what's happening. "Bibilisan natin!" means rings are about to speed up. "Mahangin ba?!" means wind is coming.

10. The Crowd Knows: When the crowd cheers at combo milestones (10, 20, 30...), it means you're doing great. That cheering sound is your reward — keep the streak alive!

16. FILIPINO WORD GLOSSARY

This game proudly uses Filipino (Tagalog) words throughout. Here is a reference for non-Filipino-speaking players:

Filipino Word	Pronunciation	English Meaning
Sipa	SEE-pah	Kick / the traditional game
Kanto	KAHN-toh	Street corner
Eskinita	es-kee-NEE-tah	Narrow alley
Sari-sari	SAH-ree SAH-ree	Variety store (corner shop)
Taya	TAH-yah	"It" (the challenger/opponent)
Swak	SWAHK	Perfect / Exact fit
Puwede	poo-WEH-deh	Can / Acceptable / Will do
Daplis	DAHP-lis	Grazed / Barely touched
Bagsak	bahg-SAHK	Fell / Dropped / Failed
Pikon	pee-KOHN	Easily angered / Sore loser
Madali	mah-DAH-lee	Easy
Sakto	sahk-TOH	Just right / Exact
Mahirap	mah-hee-RAHP	Difficult / Hard
Hangin	HAHNG-in	Wind
Bilis	BIH-lis	Speed / Fast
Dalawa	dah-LAH-wah	Two / Double
Loko-Loko	LOH-koh LOH-koh	Crazy / Chaotic
Paa	PAH-ah	Foot
Tuhod	TOO-hod	Knee
Siko	SEE-koh	Elbow
Hari	HAH-ree	King
Beterano	beh-teh-RAH-noh	Veteran

Filipino Word	Pronunciation	English Meaning
Marunong	mah-ROO-nong	Knows / Skilled
Bagito	bah-GEE-toh	Newcomer / Newbie
Kulelat	koo-LEH-lat	Last place / Dead last
Simulan	see-MOO-lan	Start / Begin
Hinto	HIN-toh	Stop / Pause
Ituloy	ee-TOO-loy	Continue / Resume
Umulit	oo-MOO-lit	Repeat / Restart
Lumabas	loo-MAH-bahs	Exit / Go out
Tira	TEE-rah	Serve / Throw
Salo	SAH-loh	Catch / Receive
Tapos	TAH-pos	Finished / Done
Chinelas	chee-NEH-lahs	Flip-flops / Slippers
Sando	SAHN-doh	Tank top / Undershirt

17. CREDITS & ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

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Sipa: Kanto Clicker is a love letter to Filipino childhood and the vibrant street culture of the Philippines. This game was designed to celebrate and preserve the traditional game of *Sipa* in a modern, accessible digital format.

Technology Stack:

- **Python 3.14** — Core game logic
- **Pygame-CE 2.5** — 2D rendering, audio, and input handling
- **Pygbag** — WebAssembly compilation for browser deployment
- **GitHub Actions** — CI/CD pipeline for automated web builds

Art & Audio:

All visuals are generated **procedurally** using Pygame drawing routines — no external image files are required. All audio (BGM, SFX, crowd cheering) is synthesized from pure Python PCM buffers at runtime. The game has **zero external asset dependencies**.

Cultural Inspiration:

The game's visual identity draws from Filipino jeepney art, sari-sari store signage, chalk court markings, neighborhood *eskinitas*, and the colorful, competitive spirit of Filipino street games. Every Filipino word used in the game is authentic Tagalog, reflecting real expressions heard in kanto culture.

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SALAMAT SA PAGLALARO!

(Thank you for playing!)

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